

Savings Rate (Percent)	Years Until Financial Independence
10	51
15	43
20	37

Unfortunately, most people don't save that much, meaning they may never achieve FI.

Let's review the three factors that govern investments and determine how much wealth we will ultimately build. Those factors are:

1. Amount of money invested (principal);
2. The rate of return on investments; and
3. Time available for money to grow and compound.

If you start saving and investing as soon as you start your career and follow the standard advice, you *should* reach FI in forty or fifty years. But this standard approach won't work if you want to achieve FI sooner. It also won't work if you are already in your forties or fifties and just starting to invest. In either case, time is not working in your favor.

If you're looking to achieve FI quickly, you will have to either increase the amount you invest, earn a higher rate of return on your investments, or do both simultaneously. The next few chapters dive